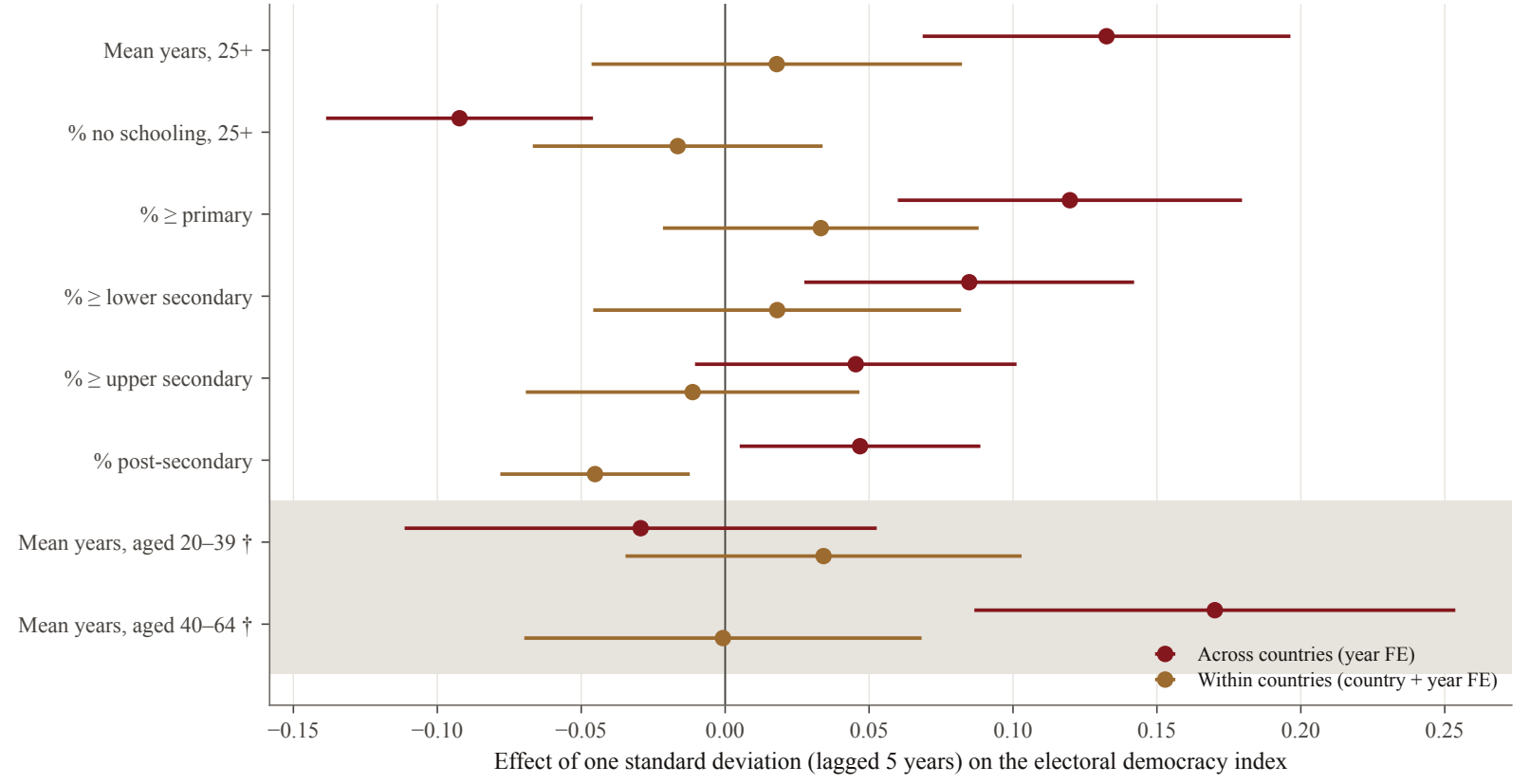
**Figure 20.** Which margin of education predicts democracy? Across countries: the bottom of the distribution, and the older cohort's schooling. Within countries over time: no positive effect




OLS of V-Dem's electoral democracy index on each education measure and log GDP pc, 5-yearly panel 1896 obs., 162 countries, 1965–2025; 95% CIs clustered by country. † Young and old entered jointly. Sources: Wittgenstein Centre v3.3; V-Dem v16; Maddison 2023.